RESEARCH METHOD

My research agent downloads the page and greps it

Claude Code's docs call its fetch tool lossy by design. One call reads up to 100,000 characters. Its own changelog page runs 1,255,400.

SWIPE

02 · the size gap

One read reaches 6 of 440 changelog entries

As of November 13, the Claude Code changelog downloads as 1,255,400 characters and 440 dated entries. The first 100,000 characters reach 6 entries, 8.0% of the page.

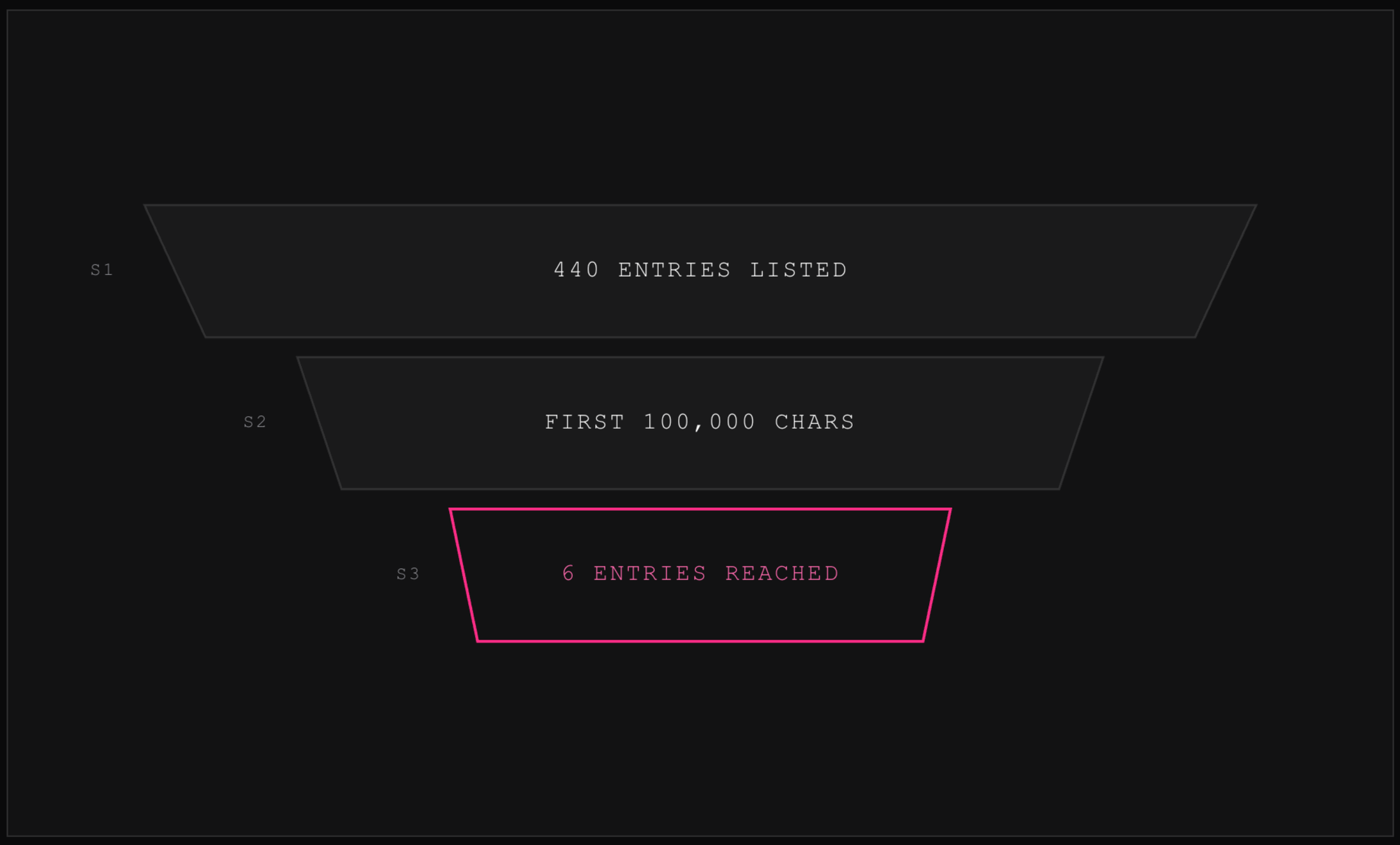


FIG. 2 · VERYDIAN

03 · docs as of Nov 13

What the fetch tool hands Claude

Per the docs, HTML becomes Markdown and, for most fetches, your prompt runs against it in a separate model call. Claude receives that result, not the raw page.

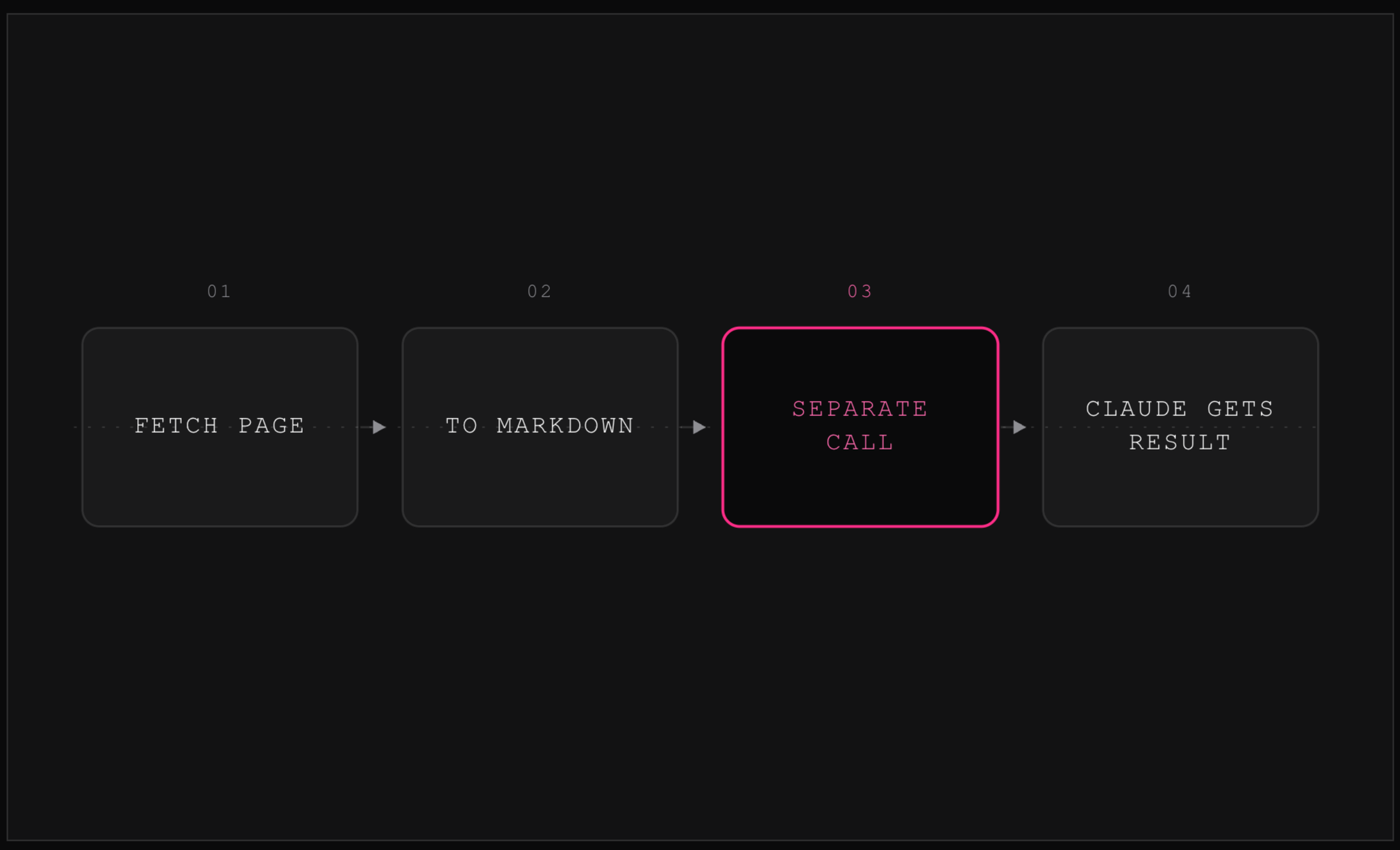


FIG. 3 · VERYDIAN

04 · the method

My agent skips the summary and reads the raw page

Since late October each source is downloaded with curl and a generic user agent, then every number or quote I plan to use is grepped as a literal substring.

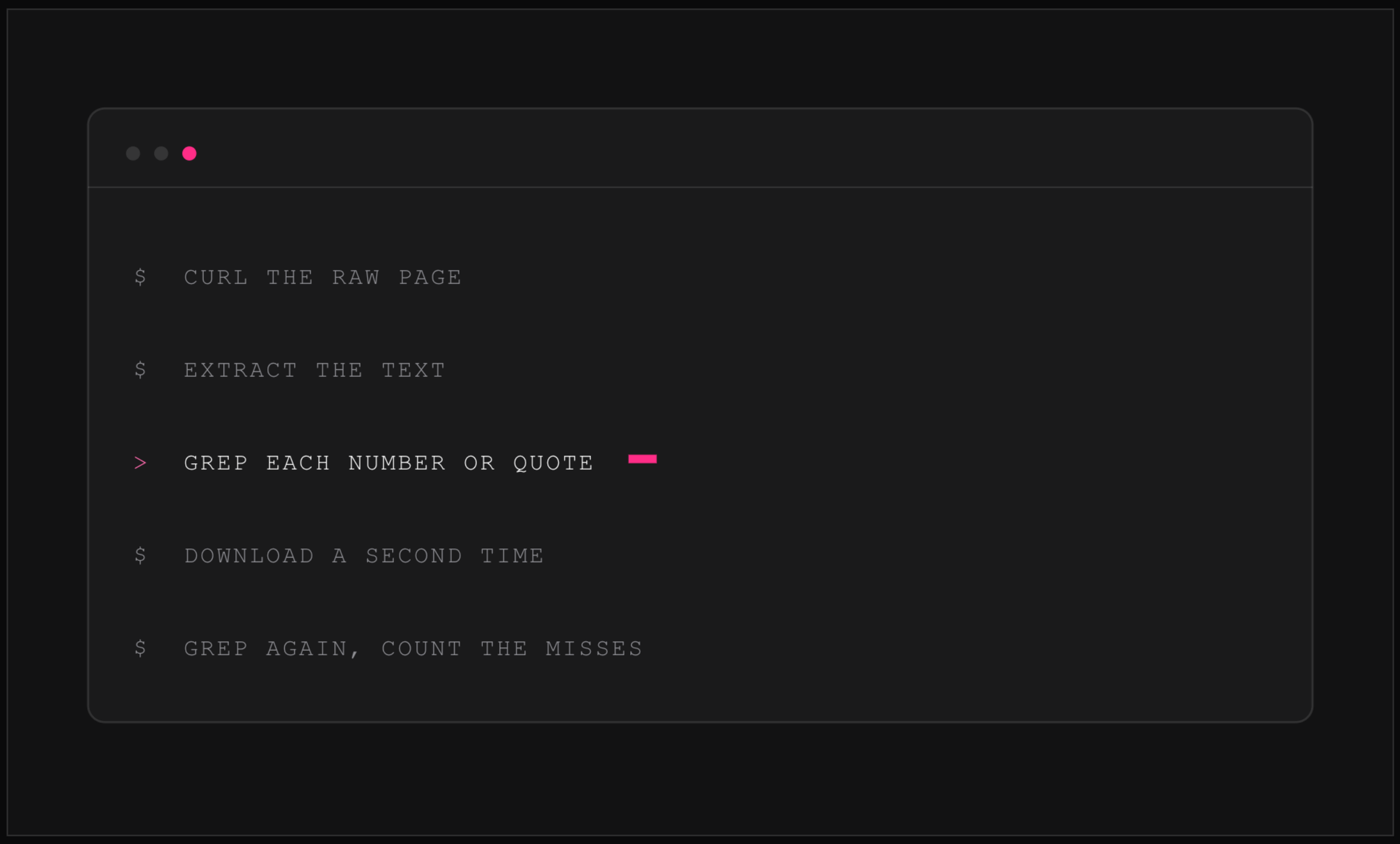


FIG. 4 · VERYDIAN

05 · the record

Four weeks of raw downloads and greps

W44: a 172KB docs page read raw. W45: the 14 MB S-1 downloaded raw. W46: 119 claims, 0 failures. W47: 97 claims in two downloads, 0 missing after one wording slip was fixed.

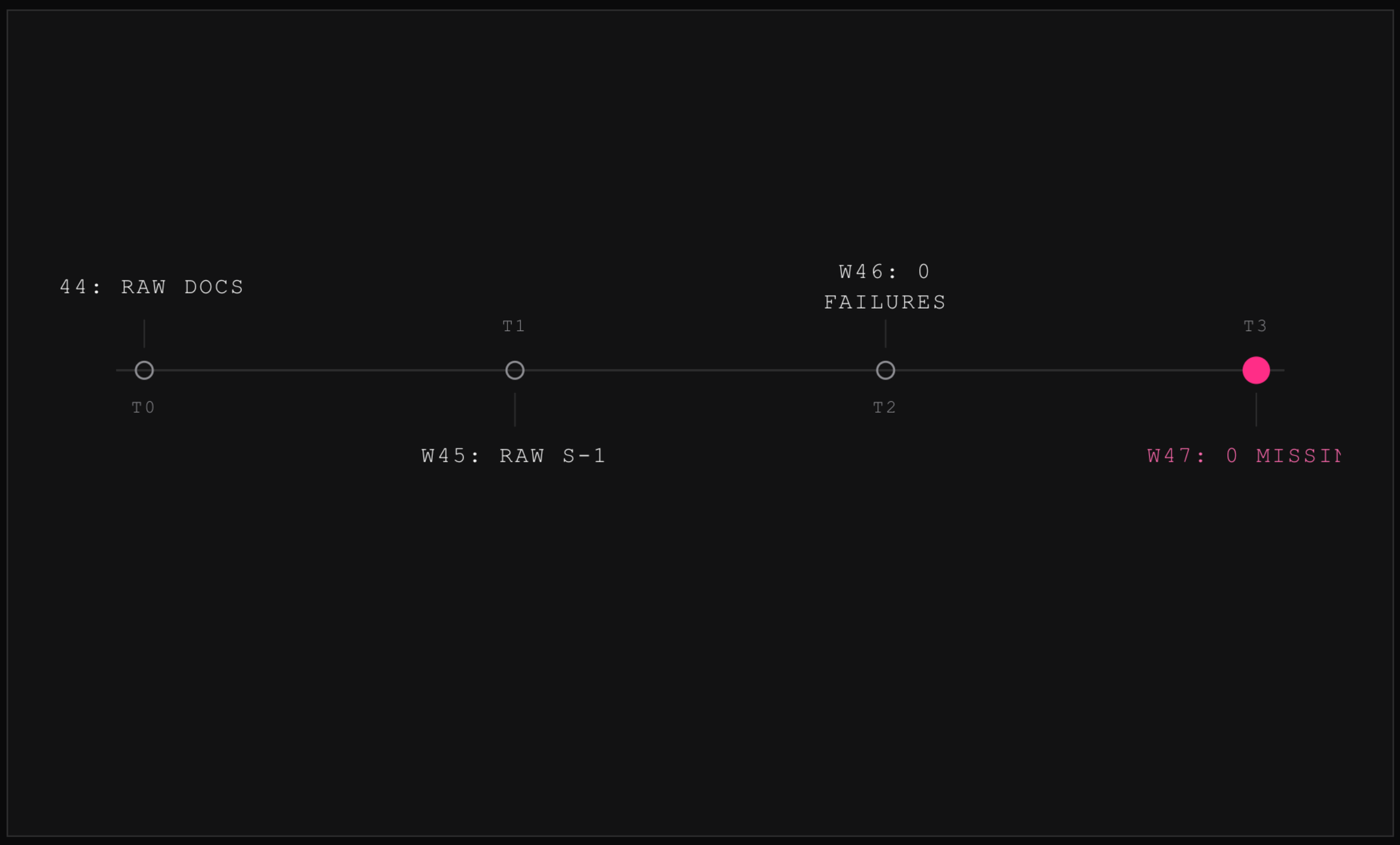


FIG. 5 · VERYDIAN

06 · the honest limit

Grep proves the page says it. Not that it's right.

A grep matches the page's words, nothing more. In W46 the editor still softened overreaches that grep could not catch, so this is one layer of several.

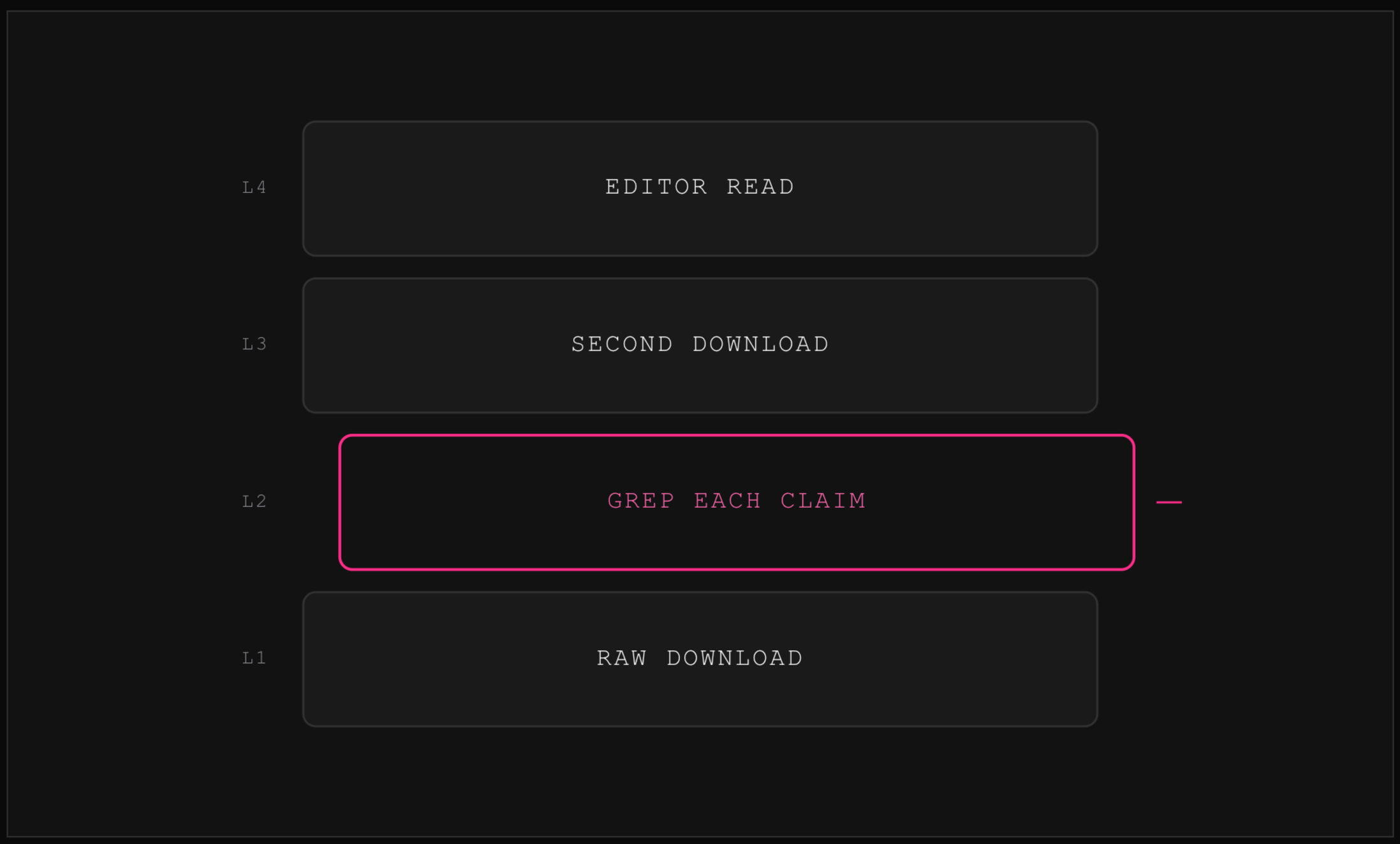


FIG. 6 · VERYDIAN



Grep the sentence before you publish it

Pick one number in your next report and find it verbatim in the source.

FIND IT VERBATIM